YOUR MAGAZINE FROM GALLIONS

thamesview

NEWS • EVENTS • COMPETITIONS

JULY 2011
www.gallionsha.co.uk



FREE DIY TRAINING

PLANNED MAINTENANCE EXPLAINED

THE LATEST FROM OUR WARDENS

Gallions Housing Association

CONTENTS

THIS ISSUE

04 Planned maintenance

06 Neighbourhood safety

08 Community garden

16 Furniture Bank

18 Block inspections











HELLO

Welcome to your new look Thamesview! We have made some changes to this edition based on the comments we received from you in our last survey.

Overall the feedback was very good, with more than 90 % of you finding the magazine informative and easy to read and understand.

With such positive feedback we decided to keep the format of the magazine the same and include your ideas and suggestions to make the magazine even better. Thank you to everyone that responded to our survey and shared their views.

We have also included a booklet about resident engagement with this issue. It explains how you can get involved with us and help monitor and improve our services. Just get in touch if you'd like more information.

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Gallions Housing Association

FREE DIY TRAINING!

"Learn how to make basic repairs and improvements in your home."



We are planning to run free DIY training sessions for residents to help you learn how to carry out basic repairs at home. So if you'd like to know how to change a tap washer, replace a toilet seat or paint a room then let us know.

The practical sessions will take place in an empty property in Thamesmead and we are hoping to run the first sessions later on in the summer. Contact us for more information.



PLANNED MAINTENANCE PROGRAMME

"Planned maintenance includes new kitchens, bathrooms, windows, roofs, re-wiring, door entry systems, external doors."

"Each year we spend around £12 million on repairing and maintaining our properties."





Every year we improve and maintain the properties in our communities. The plan on the next page shows the areas we will be improving in 2011/12.

This plan is based on a housing condition survey carried out recently, which showed that we should prioritise making improvements to homes in the Moorings area.

Internal works including new bathrooms, kitchens and re-wiring (where applicable and subject to a survey before work starts):

Bright Court
Chadwick Court
Cobden Court
Curtis Way
Hammond Way
Kingsley Court
Hazlitt Court
Leonard Robbins Path
Lytton Strachey Path
Macaulay Way
Marshall Path
Octavia Way
Ricardo Path
Rowntree Path
Shaftesbury Court
Simon Court
Wilberforce Court

External works including new windows, door entry systems, external doors, re-wiring in communal areas and roof coverings (where applicable and subject to a survey before work starts):

Booth Close
Disraeli Close
Leonard Robbins Path
Macaulay Way
Octavia Way
Marshall Path
Passfield Path

We will also carry out the following work outside of the Moorings (subject to sufficient resources being available):

Windows, Door Replacements
Aspen Green
Leatherbottle Green

Windows, Kitchens, Re-wiring
Parkway

Kitchens, Re-wiring
Whinchat Road

Windows
Temple Close

Lifts
Wyfold House
Trefoil House

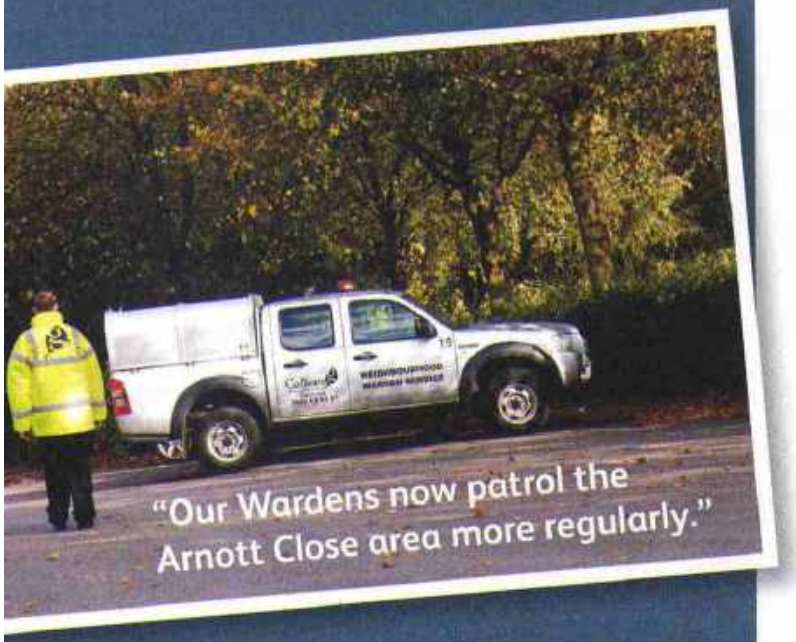
Boosted Water Supply Upgrades
Muscovy House
Argali House
Harlequin House
Dexter House

Improvements to entrances, parking and landscaping
Argali House
Harlequin House
Dexter House

New digital TV installations, door entry systems, CCTV
Various locations across Thamesmead

If you would like to find out more about our planned maintenance programme or get involved with our asset management focus group please contact us.

STREET DRINKERS IN THE MOORINGS



"Our Wardens now patrol the Arnott Close area more regularly."

Residents have told us they are concerned about street drinking and anti-social behaviour in the Arnott Close area. We have been working with police and the London Borough of Greenwich to tackle this issue using the following methods:

- The area is a Controlled Drinking Zone which means the police can confiscate alcohol from those who are behaving anti-socially
- We are now monitoring the area daily with Warden patrols and CCTV footage. The police are also increasing patrols in the area
- We have met with the drinkers that are our tenants and we are in the process of setting up Acceptable Behaviour Agreements

If you are concerned about street drinking or other anti-social behaviour please contact us.

"Four sub-let properties reclaimed every month."

CRACKING DOWN ON SUB-LETTING

So far this year, we have recovered 24 properties that were being unlawfully sub-let, which means we have been able to re-let these to people in housing need. One of these tenants was also arrested for deception and money laundering in relation to the rent she obtained for the property. She appeared at Woolwich Magistrates court and pleaded guilty to these offences.

We would like to thank residents who continue to report their suspicions to us. You can report your concerns anonymously on our website or by telephone. All reports are investigated and if you provide your details, we will let you know the outcome.



OUT WITH ANTI-SOCIAL BEHAVIOUR

"Noise nuisance complaints increase in the summer months."

Since January residents have made 410 reports of anti-social behaviour to our Enforcement Team. Most of the reports related to noise, rubbish and animals. Each case was investigated by our ASB Officers and Neighbourhood Wardens. We dealt with the reports in different ways, with many residents receiving verbal and written warnings and there has been one eviction.

In the summer months we often receive increased reports of noise nuisance due to more open windows and outdoor activities. If you are affected by noise from your neighbour you should speak to them directly as they may be unaware that their noise is disturbing you. If the situation does not improve, or you feel that you can't talk to your neighbour then just let us know.



WORKING WITH THE POLICE

"Our Wardens' local knowledge is invaluable to police."

Our Wardens work closely with the local police to help reduce crime and anti-social behaviour.

In the last couple of months they have helped police identify five people suspected of robbery, provided information about suspected drug dealing and given evidence about a car accident.

On top of this the Wardens deal with calls and emails from residents who are concerned about suspicious activities where they live.

They have made 34 tenancy checks in last two months and have identified possible sub-lets and abandoned properties.



HOW SHALL OUR GARDEN GROW?

Calling all Thamesmead residents! Moorings Action Together (M.A.T.) is a new group for local residents. They work in the Moorings area of Central Thamesmead, to make it a place people choose to live, work and volunteer.

Planning is already underway to develop the Birchmere Community Garden project. If you have green fingers and would like to get involved, please get in touch! Contact John Paul Taberdo at the London Wildlife Trust on 020 7261 0047 or jptaberdo@wildlondon.org.uk.

This project is a partnership between Team Gallions, Trust Thamesmead, London Wildlife Trust and Moorings Action Together.

"Creating a community garden is a great way to improve where you live."



CONTRIBUTION WEEK SUCCESS

This May more than 50 staff members from Gallions and Axis volunteered to take part in Contribution Week, a five day project which saw staff make some great improvements in the Thamesmead community.

The week started with a tombola and a bring and buy cake sale for staff which helped to raise £450 for the Greenwich and Bexley Community Hospice.

For the rest of the week staff cleared gardens and added new plants at the hospice and in our parks.

Our Directors and Chief Executive joined in with painting and graffiti cleaning activities in the Moorings area to round off the week's activities.

"Contribution Week raised over £450 for local hospice"

TUMP IT UP!

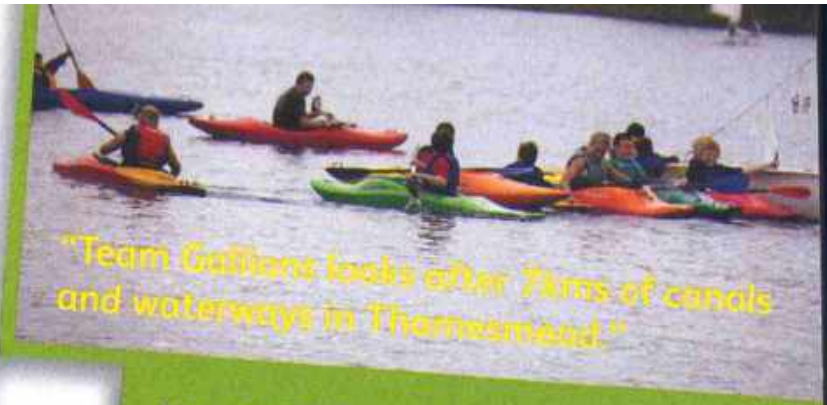


Trees for Cities

"Community day at Tump 53 this August"

Gallions is working with Trees for Cities and Thames 21 to help residents get involved with looking after and enjoying the wildlife at Tump 53, off Bentham Road. Come along to the next event on Saturday 20 August between 11am – 3pm to see what the Tump has to offer.

There will be a chance for you to help look after the nature reserve and enjoy fun nature themed games. Everyone is welcome and children must be accompanied by an adult. No previous experience or knowledge is needed, all equipment and instructions will be provided. Just wear clothes and shoes suitable for outdoor working. Contact Richard on 0207 820 4420 to find out more.



"Team Gallions looks after 7kms of canals and waterways in Thamesmead."

NEW MEMBERS NEEDED!

We are looking for new members to join the Team Gallions Interest Group. The group meets every two months to discuss how well Team Gallions delivers its services. This includes cleaning in our blocks and looking after the parks, waterways and open spaces that we own in Thamesmead. Tenants, leaseholders or freeholders are all welcome. The next meeting will take place in September, call us if you'd like to attend.



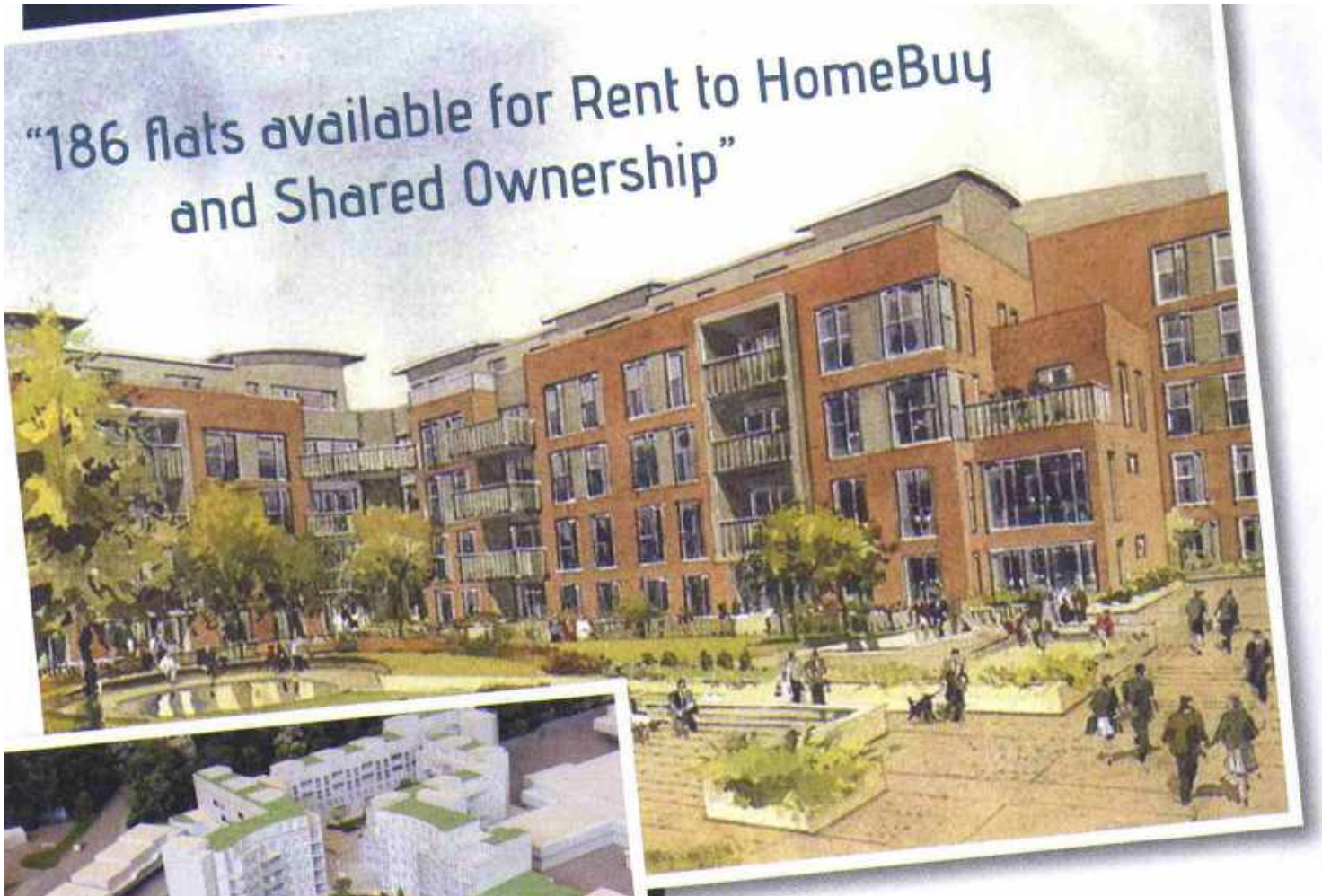
LOVE OUR PARKS

Now that summer is here don't forget to make the most of the parks and open spaces all over Thamesmead. To find out more about the facilities and events in our parks contact Team Gallions or visit our website.

- Birchmere Park – great for families!
- Southmere Park – lots of wildlife
- Crossways – sporting and adventure
- Gallions – anglers paradise

"All our parks are free to use!"

"186 flats available for Rent to HomeBuy and Shared Ownership"





If you would like to buy your own property, then FIRST STEPS Shared Ownership could be the answer!

With this scheme you can buy a share of a housing association property and pay rent on the rest.

Over time you can buy extra shares until you own the property outright.

There are lots of schemes available across London, including our brand new development in Crayford Town Centre.

Once all the building work is finished in 2012 there will be a total of 186 flats, a library, community centre, doctor's surgery, shops and restaurants.

The homes are available for eligible people who are registered with FIRST STEPS on a Shared Ownership or Rent to HomeBuy basis.

To find out if you are eligible and to view all the properties currently available visit www.firststepslondon.org or call 0844 406 9997.

RESIDENT INSPECTOR RESULTS

Our Resident Inspectors have been checking the standard of cleaning in communal areas in our tower blocks since September last year. They look at around six blocks every three months to give a snapshot of how we are doing.

Here are their findings:

	SEPTEMBER 10	NOVEMBER 10	MARCH 11
Walls	good	good	unsatisfactory
Ceiling	satisfactory	satisfactory	unsatisfactory
Lights	good	good	unsatisfactory
Floors	satisfactory	good	unsatisfactory
Windows	good	good	unsatisfactory
Balustrades	good	good	good
Waste Disposal	good	good	good
Graffiti	good	good	good
Fly posting	good	good	good

Where the Resident Inspectors have told us cleaning is unsatisfactory we have investigated and made the improvements needed.

Every month our Resident Inspectors look at some of our empty properties before they are offered to new tenants. This helps us double check that our homes are of the right standard. The inspectors rate each property out of 10 and tell us about any areas of concern.

Here are their scores:

	FEBRUARY 2011	MARCH 2011	APRIL 2011	MAY 2011
Average Score out of 10	7.3	5.33	6.5	6.5

As a result of their comments over the past 18 months we have started to decorate halls, put up net curtains and paint front doors before residents move in.

To find out more about the Resident Inspectors and how residents can help monitor our performance just contact us.

"30 Resident Inspectors work with us to check the cleaning in shared areas and standards in empty properties"

PRE-SCHOOL PLACES AVAILABLE IN THAMESMEAD



"Acorn Pre-school rated outstanding by Ofsted"

Trust Thamesmead's two pre-schools, Acorn and Arnott, are now enrolling children for the new school year, starting 5 September 2011. Arnott Pre-school based in Arnott Close, off Bentham Road, received 'Good' in their latest Ofsted report. They have spacious indoor and outdoor areas for children aged 3-5 years and all staff have Early Years qualifications. Acorn Pre-school based in Glimpsing Green, off Yarnton Way, received 'Outstanding' in their last two Ofsted reports. They operate from a self-contained building and also have spacious indoor and outdoor areas.

Both pre-schools offer safe, friendly and stimulating environments and operate 39 weeks a year, providing sessions from 9:00am-12:00pm and 12:30pm-3:30pm, Monday-Friday during term time and excluding Bank Holidays. For more information or to enrol your child contact Acorn Pre-school on 020 8310 0782 (Sara) or Arnott Pre-school on 020 8319 7477 (Claire).

STOP BY AND SAY HELLO!

If you haven't visited us in our office at 90 Titmuss Avenue yet please drop in. You will find all the usual services inside, and our reception staff are on hand to help with any queries you have too.

Don't forget that we have two new phone numbers – 0300 123 1237 for general enquiries and 0300 123 1238 for repairs. Our phone lines are available 8am – 6pm Monday to Friday (excluding bank holidays). An emergency only service is in place at all other times.



"Our residents office is open 9am-5pm Monday, Tuesday, Thursday, Friday and 9am-6pm on Wednesday"

USING COMPLAINTS TO IMPROVE

"We have changed our services because of your feedback."

When we receive complaints, comments or compliments from our residents we use this information to improve what we do. Here are just a couple of examples of where we have made changes to our service because of feedback:

Complaint: The form for choices about home improvements is confusing.

Action: The form has been changed so that customers tick and put their initials next to the choices on the form. This helps prevent confusion for the resident and contractor.

Complaint: There's no follow-up after a communal repair.

Action: We have given staff training and updated our systems to improve the communal repairs service.

Complaint: The lighting in my car parking area is poor.

Action: We have installed additional high level lighting in the area.

If you have a complaint, comment or compliment please share it with us. You can call us, visit our office or fill in the form on our website.

FABULOUS FEEDBACK!



Thank you to everyone that filled in our survey and shared their views about Thamesview. Overall, the feedback was excellent – 98 % of you said it was informative and 94 % said it was easy to read.

We have made some changes in this edition of the magazine because of your feedback. A number of you wanted to know more about the enforcement work the Wardens carry out so we have included lots of information about what the wardens do on these pages. Well done to Kelly Errington in Slade Green who was the winner of our survey prize draw. If you have any feedback about the magazine or would like to join our Editorial Team just get in touch.

"96% of readers said Thamesview was good or very good"

DATES FOR YOUR DIARY

PICNIC IN YOUR PARK

BIRCHMERE PARK – THAMESMEAD

11 & 24 August »12pm to 3pm » www.gallionsha.co.uk » 0300 123 1237

THAI FESTIVAL

DANSON PARK – BEXLEYHEATH

13 & 14 August »11am to 6pm » www.visitthaifestival.com

FAMILY FUN DAY

WELL HALL PLEASAUNCE – ELTHAM

28 August » 10am to 6pm » www.greenwich.gov.uk » 020 8854 8888

OPEN HOUSE WEEKEND

OLD ROYAL NAVAL COLLEGE

17 & 18 September » 10am to 4.30pm » www.oldroyalnavalcollege.org

020 8269 4747



A	N	Q	R	W	T	E	R	R	H	T	U	Y
J	R	K	T	L	Y	S	E	M	A	J	T	S
H	C	G	X	H	Z	D	A	S	I	A	S	T
L	B	B	E	Y	F	E	G	R	G	T	T	N
U	I	I	L	D	P	P	O	L	K	O	J	E
Z	G	R	E	E	N	W	I	C	H	G	C	G
B	X	C	H	C	V	J	X	K	E	L	V	E
A	E	H	Y	X	Q	C	E	V	G	B	P	R
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M	I	R	G	B	P	A	L	Z	T	X	J	C
V	L	E	F	N	T	M	I	Q	S	W	A	E
R	C	T	V	Y	B	U	N	I	M	O	U	P

WIN WITH OUR WORDSEARCH

Now that summer's here we can all enjoy the great outdoors. In this wordsearch we have hidden the names of six local parks. Find them all and you could win a £30 shopping voucher.

BIRCHMERE
DANSON
GREENWICH
HYDE
REGENTS
ST JAMES

DID YOU KNOW...

Hyde Park is London's largest and most famous park. It is located close to many famous landmarks like Buckingham Palace and Harrods. It has a boating lake, fishing, jogging trails and a statue of Peter Pan. If you are brave enough you can swim in the lido from June to September!

Please return your completed wordsearch and details to: Anita Dagger, Gallions Housing Association, Freepost RSLT-LYEG-HZAL, PO Box 268, Sidcup, DA15 0FB or drop it into our reception by 26th August 2011. The winner will be selected at random.

Name: .....

Address: .....

.....

.....

Telephone: .....

Email: .....

Congratulations to Yu Kari Hung of Lime Row who was the winner of our last wordsearch competition.

Tenants view...

It's that time again; summer is in full swing and the school holidays are here!

If you want to keep your little ones busy during the summer there are plenty of activities and events featured in this magazine and on the Gallions website.

Have a lovely summer!



New GRG members

"Gallions Residents Group works with us to improve our services"

We have recently welcomed two new residents to the Gallions Residents Group (GRG); Sheila Fagg from Slade Green and Con Lobo from the Moorings area.

Recently the GRG Monitoring Group met with managers to discuss our Planned Maintenance Programme and how the Customer Contact Team works. GRG members suggested that the signage at our office in Titmuss Avenue should be improved - the sign has now been moved away from the trees and a larger banner has been ordered.

We still have places available on the GRG, so if you would like to be involved in working in partnership with Gallions to challenge poor performance and make recommendations for improvement just contact us.

Thamesmead Furniture Recycle

"Pick up good quality used furniture at reasonable prices"

Thamesmead Furniture Recycle is a great service that helps local residents recycle their unwanted furniture within the community. The shop at Tavy Bridge has been so busy that it's now open more often; on both the second and last Tuesday of every month between 10am and 12pm. We are also hoping to extend the service and offer collection and delivery later this year.

If you have an unwanted wardrobe, table, chest of drawers, bric-a-brac or something similar that is still in good condition you can donate it. Contact Trust Thamesmead on 020 8320 4470 to find out about making a donation or collecting a piece of furniture.

Community funding available

"The GRG can help your club or group"

Gallions Residents Group has a small amount of funding available to help local community groups set up projects or events.

They recently awarded grants to the Monday Club and the Wednesday Club, who provide social activities for older people in Thamesmead, to go on trips to the seaside.

If you would like more information about applying for funding please contact Helen Chambers on 0300 123 1237.



Picnics in your park

"Free face painting and bouncy castles in Birchmere Park"

This summer don't miss the free family events taking place in Birchmere Park from 12 noon on Thursday 11th and Wednesday 24th August. The events have been organised by the GRG and Trust Thamesmead, with support from Axis and are open to everyone. On both days you'll find children's entertainment, bouncy castles, a disco, face painting available - all you need to do is bring your own picnic!

Calling all drama queens (and kings!)

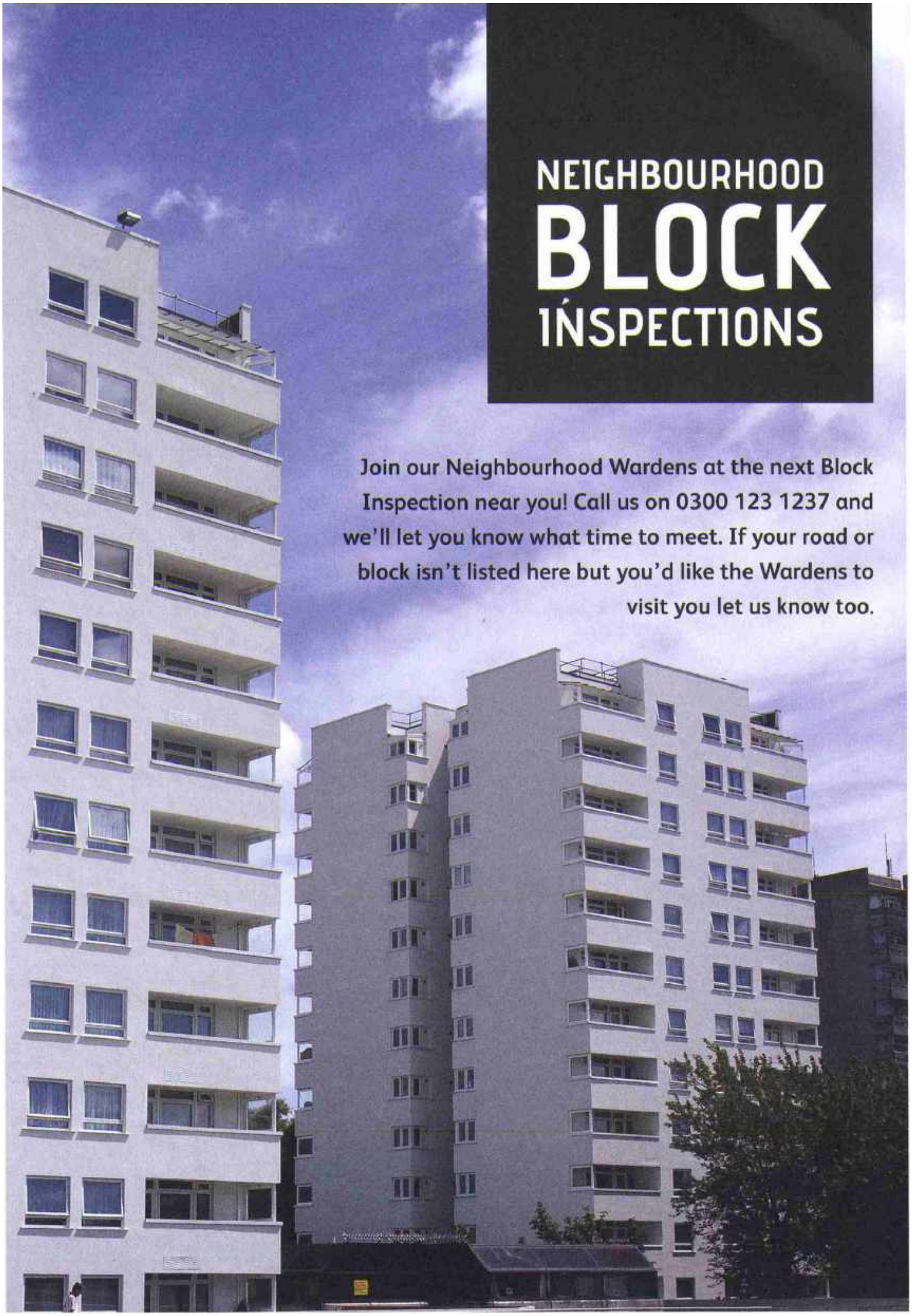
"New kids drama classes in Thamesmead"

If your youngster wants to try something new this summer then check out the drama classes offered by Cadz Productions.

The classes are for kids aged 7 – 15 and no acting experience is necessary to get started! Sessions cost £2 and they run on Saturday afternoons at Arnott Community Centre and Monday evenings at Abbey Wood Community Centre.

Contact Kate on 07834 044 438 or visit www.cadzproductions.co.uk for more information.




NEIGHBOURHOOD
BLOCK
INSPECTIONS
Join our Neighbourhood Wardens at the next Block Inspection near you! Call us on 0300 123 1237 and we'll let you know what time to meet. If your road or block isn't listed here but you'd like the Wardens to visit you let us know too.

ABBEY WOOD

8 August
St Josephs Court
Felixstowe Road

22 September
St Josephs Court
Felixstowe Road

BROADWATERS

3 August
Bridge House
Tump House
Hill House

9 August
Whinchat Road
Wren Path

10 August
Wigeon Path
Redwing Path

16 September
Bridge House
Tump House
Hill House

23 September
Whinchat Road
Wren Path

28 September
Wigeon Path
Redwing Path

CROSSWAY

16 August
Phoenix Point
Ringside Court

19 September
Phoenix Point
Ringside Court

GREENMEAD

19 September
Lime Row

LESNES

5 August
Coralline Walk
Evenlode House

15 August
Clewer House
Maplin House
Wyfold House

22 August
Hibernia House
Radley House
Duxford House

20 September
Clewer House
Maplin House
Wyfold House

29 September
Coralline Walk
Evenlode House

MOORINGS

24 August
Harold Wilson House

1 September
Besant Court
Mill Court
Cross Court

2 September
Simon Court
Chadwick Court
Manning Court

9 September
Keynes Court
Webb Court
Raymond Postgate Ct

13 September
Lansbury Court,
Beveridge Court

PARKVIEW

4 August
Shire Court
Teeswater Court
Buckwheat Court

19 August
Maran Way
Argali House
Dexter House
Harlequin House

25 August
Masham House
Jacob House
Clydesdale House

1 September
Trefoil House
Timothy House
Muscovy House

21 September
Shire Court
Teeswater Court
Buckwheat Court

SLADE GREEN

8 August
Old Church Court

22 September
Old Church Court

SOUTHMERE

1 August
Oakenholt House
Trewsbury House
Penton House
Osney House

7 September
Tavy Bridge
Binsey Walk

8 September
Tilehurst Point
Blewbury House

14 September
Deal Court
Staplehurst Court

15 September
Oakenholt House
Trewsbury House
Penton House
Osney House

TOWER HAMLETS

2 August
Millharbour
St Annes
Carmine Wharf

26 September
Millharbour
St Annes
Carmine Wharf

WATERFIELD

17 August
Cobden Court
Bright Court
Hazlitt Court

23 August
Shaftesbury Court
Wilberforce Court
Kingsley Court

18 August
Disraeli Close

27 September
Cobden Court
Bright Court
Hazlitt Court

HOW WELL ARE WE DOING?

This performance chart shows our performance as a landlord during this financial year compared to 2010. If you would like to join our residents group and help us monitor and improve what we do please contact us.

Description	2010/11	2011/12	Target	Performance Trend	Current Status
Overall satisfaction with service	82%	82%	75%	↔	☺
Void re-let period (a lower figure is better)	30 days	28 days	26 days	↑	☹
Emergency repairs completed within timescale	99%	99%	98%	↔	☺
Calls answered within 20 seconds	83%	89%	80%	↑	☺
Complaints answered within timescale	90%	95%	90%	↑	☺
Satisfaction with anti-social behaviour process	91%	100%	84%	↑	☺
Rent collected	99%	91%	100%	↓	☹

Performance Status		Overall Performance Trend	
☹	Performance is below target	↑	Performance is better than last year
☺	Performance is above target	↓	Performance is worse than last year
		↔	Performance is the same as last year

HOMEOWNER NEWS

BUILDINGS INSURANCE

We have recently appointed Acumus as our new insurance provider, following the consultation with leaseholders. All Gallions leaseholders are insured through this company automatically. If you live in a house, you may opt out and use your own insurer but you must provide us with a copy of your policy on an annual basis or you will still be billed. If you need a copy of the summary of cover to give to your mortgage lender, please contact us.

REPLACEMENT WINDOWS

In most cases, Gallions are responsible for the maintenance of your window frames, which we do on your behalf. If we replace the windows, you will be recharged for these but we will continue to maintain them. If you choose to replace the windows yourself then Gallions will not maintain the new windows. If we are replacing windows in your block and there are communal windows, you will be charged a proportion of the costs for replacing these even if your own windows are not replaced.

GETTING IN TOUCH

If you need to contact the homeowner team you should call 0300 123 1237 or email homeownerteam@gallionsha.co.uk. If you are sub-letting your property you should provide us with details of the agents who manage your property or your tenant's name and telephone number in case of emergency.

UPDATING YOUR HOME

If you want to make any alterations to your property please remember that under the terms of your lease you need to write to us outlining your intentions and wait for our response before you undertake any work.

ANNUAL BOILER CHECKS

Your gas supplier will not be so busy now the summer is here so it's a good time to book in your annual boiler check!

Gallions Housing Association

Southmere Village update

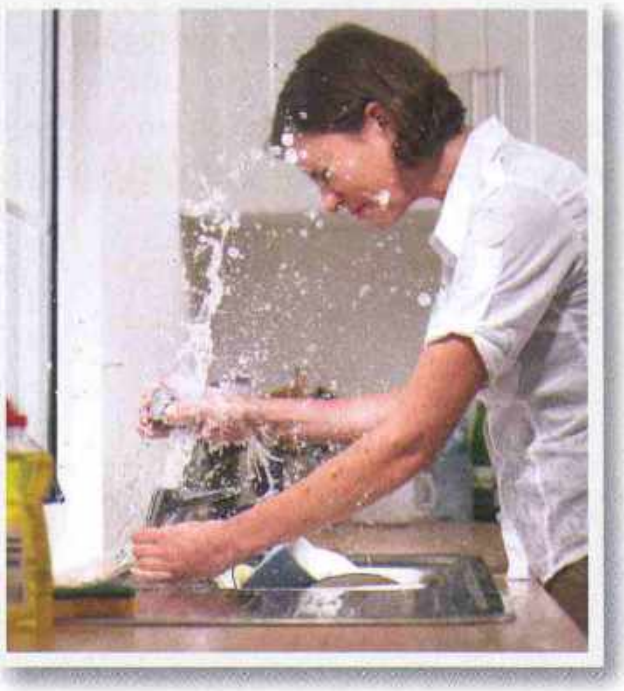
There have been some delays to the regeneration project at Southmere Village (formerly Tavy Bridge) due to funding issues and the economic downturn.

We have been able to get some funding to keep the project on track so we have already inspected some blocks in Binsey Walk to see where improvements can be made to external areas and empty properties.

We will be stripping out and securing all empty properties in other areas of Binsey Walk and Tavy Bridge this month too. For more information about the works contact us.



Tip top taps



If your water is temporarily cut off please make sure you turn off the taps before you leave home. Sometimes the water comes back on when residents are out and this causes a flood in the home and the property below.

Remember you must take out your own contents insurance to protect the belongings in your home and those of your neighbour. Contact us for more information about contents insurance on 0300 123 1237.

The 'green house' effect!

We have just launched a brand new online video to help you save energy and money. Visit www.gallionsha.co.uk/energy and you will be able to navigate through different rooms in our special 'green house' and find out the best ways to reduce your energy usage and bills.



New caretakers service

This month we have introduced a new caretaker service in all our blocks in Thamesmead. We ran a trial of the service last year and the feedback from residents was very good, so we have rolled out the scheme to more properties.

Each of our blocks now has a named caretaker who is responsible for cleaning in communal areas. Our caretakers are easy to spot as they all wear green t-shirts! Check your block noticeboard to find out who your caretaker is and their contact details. We will let you know how the new service is going in future editions of Thamesview magazine.

Free training and careers advice

If you have been out of work for 12 months or more and aren't claiming Job Seekers Allowance you could be eligible for a new jobs and training scheme run by GLLab (Greenwich Local Labour and Business).

You will get help with paid and unpaid work experience, looking for a job, creating or improving your CV, job applications, in-work support, mentoring and training. Call 020 8312 7960 for more information.



Contact us



If you would like more information about any of the stories in this edition please contact us on 0300 123 1237 and ask for the relevant team.

Resident Engagement Team – Free DIY Training, Resident Inspectors, GRG, Picnics in the Park, Improving Performance

Asset Management Team – Planned Maintenance Programme

Enforcement Team – Street Drinkers, Sub-Letting, ASB, The Wardens, Block Inspections

Team Gallions – Parks and Open Spaces, Cleaning, Team Gallions Interest Group, Caretakers

Homeowner Team – Homeowner News

Customer Contact Team – anything else!

KidsView WORDSEARCH

We have hidden the names of six musical instruments in this wordsearch. Find them all and you could win a music fun pack!



A	R	Q	R	E	V	G	Y	B	U	B	I	P
A	D	S	F	D	G	I	H	G	J	K	J	L
S	J	A	G	Z	U	X	O	C	D	V	S	B
N	D	R	U	M	S	T	T	L	J	F	K	G
H	G	J	I	K	T	L	R	Q	I	O	A	E
E	R	W	T	Q	Y	C	O	I	I	N	O	H
F	A	G	A	H	L	J	M	K	U	A	N	P
J	D	H	R	G	A	F	B	D	X	I	C	Z
K	P	U	K	Y	L	R	O	N	U	P	L	C
I	O	U	O	Y	Y	T	N	R	E	E	K	W
L	M	K	B	J	C	H	E	G	D	F	C	D
Y	A	U	C	I	L	O	A	P	D	A	U	S
T	T	R	I	A	N	G	L	E	M	A	L	S

DRUMS
GUITAR
PIANO
TROMBONE
TRIANGLE
VIOLIN

This competition is just for kids under 12. Please return your completed wordsearch and details to: Anita Dagger, Gallions Housing Association, Freepost RSLT-LYEG-HZAL, PO Box 268, Sidcup, DA15 0FB or drop it into our reception by 26th August 2011. The winner will be selected at random.

Child's name:

Parent's name:

Address:

Telephone:

Well done to Samsara of Cole Close who was the winner of our last competition.

All About Resident Engagement



Gallions Housing Association

This document is a summary of our latest Resident Engagement strategy and includes information about how you can get involved with Gallions and help improve the services we provide. It also tells you about how we will communicate with you.

If you would like a copy of our full strategy you can download one from our website or call us on 0300 123 1237 and request one.

The information you receive

We will make sure that the information we send to you is available in large print, audio formats, translated versions and in Braille.

Information will be provided to you in these ways:

- Thamesview magazine
- Letters and leaflets
- Posters and noticeboards
- Email and website
- The Annual Report (in October)
- Face to face contact
- Meetings between Gallions and residents

We will work with Gallions Residents Group to make sure that the information we send out is relevant and of a good quality.

Getting involved

There are lots of ways you can get involved with us and help improve our services. Our involvement opportunities have different levels of time commitment;

Low level – These are usually one-off or short term activities

- Providing information on what is happening where you live
- Completing surveys about how you feel about services provided
- Joining Service Focus Groups to review service standards and ways of improving what we do

Medium level – You may need to attend meetings or give detailed feedback

- Helping to develop Neighbourhood Improvement Plans
- Consulting with us on the design of new properties
- Mystery Shopping
- Becoming a Resident Inspector
- Joining a Consultation Group to look at specific issues

High level – This often includes monthly meetings and decision making

- Becoming a Gallions Housing Association Board member and agreeing the strategy and way forward
- Joining Gallions Residents Group to help monitor the quality of services
- Represent the interests of local residents in Tenant and Resident Associations

Support available

We can help and support you if you would like to get involved with us, this includes:

- Yearly grants to run residents groups
- Support and advice from Gallions staff
- Funding out of pocket expenses for resident representatives
- Access to independent advice – we are members of the Tenant Participation Advisory Service (TPAS)
- Training courses

Standards for meetings and resident groups

We have standards in place for meetings and residents groups so you know what will happen if you get involved with us. The standards set out what residents can expect of Gallions and what Gallions can expect of engaged or involved residents. Just ask us for a copy of the standards.

Local Offers

The Tenant Services Authority (TSA) is our regulator and they have asked us to work with residents to develop Local Offers. These offers are a range of local standards which help us to deliver services tailored to local needs:

1. Tenant Involvement and Empowerment – This standard is critical to involving residents in regulation and governance. It ensures that residents can get involved in the management of their housing and deciding key standards. It covers customer service, choice, complaints, equality and diversity and support needs.

2. Neighbourhood and Community – This standard requires housing providers to work in partnership with residents and other agencies to tackle anti-social behaviour and to keep communal areas clean and safe.

We offer a comprehensive translation service to make communicating with us easy. If you would like Thamesview Magazine translated into your own language or need an audio, large print or Braille version please contact us.

☎: 0300 123 1237
✉: translations@gallionsha.co.uk

Chúng tôi cung cấp dịch vụ biên dịch cho tất cả các loại ngôn ngữ để giúp quí vị dễ dàng liên lạc với chúng tôi. Nếu quí vị muốn cuốn Tạp chí Thamesview này được dịch sang ngôn ngữ của quí vị hoặc quí vị cần một phiên bản khác bằng âm thanh, in khổ lớn hoặc Chữ nổi, xin hãy liên hệ với chúng tôi.

我們提供廣泛的語言翻譯服務，令您能更方便地與我們交流。如果您需要將「Thamesview 雜誌」翻譯為您所使用的語言，或需要音訊版本、大字體印刷版本或盲文版本，請與我們取得聯繫。

ਸਾਡੇ ਨਾਲ ਪੱਤਰ-ਵਿਹਾਰ ਨੂੰ ਅਸਾਨ ਬਨਾਉਣ ਲਈ ਅਸੀਂ ਇੱਕ ਵਿਆਪਕ ਅਨੁਵਾਦ ਸੇਵਾ ਪੇਸ਼ ਕਰਦੇ ਹਾਂ। ਜੇ ਤੁਸੀਂ ਥੇਮਜ਼ਵਿਊ ਮੈਗਜ਼ੀਨ ਦਾ ਆਪਣੀ ਭਾਸ਼ਾ ਵਿੱਚ ਅਨੁਵਾਦ ਕਰਵਾਉਣਾ ਚਾਹੋ ਜਾਂ ਤੁਹਾਨੂੰ ਆਡੀਓ, ਵੱਡੇ ਅੱਖਰਾਂ ਜਾਂ ਬ੍ਰੇਲ ਵਿੱਚ ਰੂਪਾਂਤਰ ਚਾਹੀਦਾ ਹੋਵੇ ਕਿਰਪਾ ਤਾਂ ਕਰਕੇ ਸਾਡੇ ਨਾਲ ਸੰਪਰਕ ਕਰੋ।

আমরা আমাদের সাথে যোগাযোগ সহজ করার জন্য একটি ব্যাপক অনুবাদ পরিষেবা প্রদান করে থাকি। আপনি যদি টেমসভিউ ম্যাগাজিনকে আপনার মাতৃভাষায় অনুবাদ হিসেবে পেতে চান বা একটি অডিও, বড় হরফের মুদ্রন বা ব্রেইল রূপ পেতে চান অনুগ্রহ করে আমাদের সাথে যোগাযোগ করুন।

Gallions Housing Association